Rafael Monteiro

Backend Engineer · Go & PostgreSQL

Nine years of building server-side systems, the last four and a half in payments. I like boring technology, small services with clear contracts, and dashboards that tell me before the customer does. Moved from São Paulo to Cologne in 2022 on an EU Blue Card; permanent residence since 2025.

EXPERIENCE

Backend Engineer

Kolibri Payments GmbH, Cologne · Mar 2022 – present

- Own the payout service (Go, PostgreSQL) that settles roughly 40,000 merchant transfers per day to German and Dutch banks via SEPA batch files
- Replaced a cron-based reconciliation job with an event-driven flow on RabbitMQ; mismatches are now found within minutes instead of the next morning
- Introduced contract-first API design for the team: every public endpoint starts as a reviewed spec, clients are generated
- CI/CD with GitHub Actions: tests against a real Postgres in the pipeline, Docker images deployed to Hetzner Cloud hosts; on-call one week in five
- Led the PSD2 strong-customer-authentication change together with the compliance team (2023), two releases, no incidents

Software Engineer

Tupi Software Ltda., São Paulo · Aug 2019 – Jan 2022

- Product company for restaurant delivery; moved order-tracking from a PHP monolith into two Go services with MySQL, later PostgreSQL
- Built the courier location API (around 2,000 writes per second at lunchtime), load-tested with k6
- Mentored two interns; wrote the team's first on-call runbook

Junior Developer

Banco Horizonte S.A., São Paulo · Jun 2017 – Jul 2019

- Maintenance of Java batch jobs for account statements; migration of stored procedures from Oracle to PostgreSQL
- Wrote the integration tests the team had been postponing for years (JUnit, Testcontainers)

EDUCATION

B.Sc. Computer Science

Universidade de São Paulo (USP) · Feb 2013 – Dec 2016

- Final project: a fault-tolerant message queue in Go (grade 9.2/10); exchange semester at RWTH Aachen (2015)

TALKS & COMMUNITY

- "Idempotency keys in practice", Cologne Gophers meetup, March 2025
- Occasional contributor to pgx (bug reports, one merged fix)

Cologne, 12 October 2026

CONTACT

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github.com/rmonteiro-dev
Born 14 May 1995, São Paulo
Brazilian citizen, permanent residence (DE)

SKILLS

Languages

Go (since 2016, daily since 2019)
SQL, Bash
Java (legacy maintenance), PHP (reading)

Data & messaging

PostgreSQL (schema design, tuning, pgx)
Redis (caching, rate limiting)
MySQL, Oracle (older projects)
RabbitMQ

APIs & tooling

REST, OpenAPI (Swagger) specs, oapi-codegen
Docker, Docker Compose
GitHub Actions, Make
Grafana, Prometheus metrics, Sentry
k6, Testcontainers

LANGUAGES

Portuguese – native
English – fluent (working language since 2019)
German – B2 (telc certificate 2025, daily at the office)

CERTIFICATES

PostgreSQL Associate (EDB), 2023
telc Deutsch B2, 2025

PERSONAL

Futsal on Wednesdays, FC Ehrenfeld

Home espresso, far too seriously